Happy on His Own Terms

YouTuber **Bhuvan Bam** on his OTT leap with *Taaza Khabar* and why having creative control is important to him

with Suhani Singh

Q. Why take *Taaza Khabar* to Disney+ Hotstar and not put it up on your YouTube channel?
I didn't want to make *BB Ki Vines* a hub for every content piece I make. YouTube has given me everything and I'm indebted to them forever. But how do I change the perception that I can only shoot with a muffler or with a moustache on? If I want to explore more with acting, then OTT is an avenue. *Taaza Khabar* is that leap of faith for me. With Hotstar you get a mass-y audience.

Q. YouTube has also changed a lot since you started.
It has to. People are focusing on shorts. What other people used to think of YouTubers [earlier] is how YouTubers feel about short-form content today. I'm not looking down upon any content, but at times I feel that from five-six minutes people have come down to 30 seconds. Where is entertainment headed?

Q. The show is a *BB Ki Vines* production. Why produce everything you make?
I want that creative control. All my life I have been stuck with regrets of seniority, that I can't tell them what I feel. When I feel something is wrong on the set, there has to be some scope for argument. I want to work with others, but as co-producer.

Q. Does Bhuvan Bam want to take the leap to the big screen?
Right now, the wave is, you pick up a popular Instagrammer or YouTuber, give them a side role and promise them that 'this will change your life'. I have been to many narrations at big production houses where the marketing guy is involved, and not the writer or the director, and the first thing they ask is, 'How do you think you will promote this?' So long as I am adding something to the plot and the story, I will do it. I don't want to be an *aloo* [potato] who can be stuffed anywhere.